

Full Programme Proposal Format

Date of submission	dd/mm/yyyy (the date should be updated whenever the proposal is revised and resubmitted)
Benefiting country and location(s)	
Title of the programme	
Duration of programme	From dd/mm/yy to dd/mm/yy (xx months)
Lead UN organization	Give name, title and email address of the focal person in the lead UN organization, including a focal person on finance.
Implementing UN organization(s)	Give name, title and email address of the focal persons in each UN implementing organization.
Non-UN implementing partners	
Resident Coordinator(s) Resident Coordinator's Office (RCO) (For submissions from regional entities, offices of SRSGs or other similar entities, submissions can be from the highest ranking UN official)	Give name, title and email address of the focal persons in relevant RCO(s) and Regional Office(s)/HQs
Total programme budget including indirect support costs in US\$ (UNTFHS and other sources of funding)	
Amount requested from the UNTFHS in US\$ (no more than \$2million for operational programmes and no more than \$300,000 for outreach/advocacy programmes)	
Amount to be sourced from other donors in US\$ (please list each donor and the amount to be contributed)	
Target SDG(s):	

1. Executive summary

The executive summary is a brief statement of the programme. In preparing the executive summary, please consider the following:

- ☐ What is the overall purpose of the programme, and what are the expected results at the end of the programme period?
- ☐ What are the interconnected challenges being addressed, who are the main target groups, and why is it important to address this challenge now?
- ☐ Why is human security the most appropriate approach?
- ☐ How will its application advance a different way of responding to the challenge than previous interventions or ways of working?
- ☐ Who are the key partners and how have they been involved to date?
- ☐ What are the primary objective(s) and outcomes you aim to achieve?

2. Joint multidimensional human security analysis

Expanding on the concept note, the information contained in this section should be based on a comprehensive multi-sectoral analysis in which UN entities and partners adapt and combine existing analytical tools and processes to create a multidimensional and context-specific joint presentation of threats, needs, vulnerabilities and capacities, as the basis for a common approach.

0.1. Overall context analysis

- ☐ Considering the domains of human security (economic, food, health, environmental, personal, community and political), highlight critical and pervasive challenges in the targeted area and how they are interconnected, interdependent and/or compounding.
- ☐ Describe their root causes and their impact on different groups within communities as well as institutions.
- ☐ Provide relevant disaggregated qualitative and quantitative data, from national to household level where relevant.

0.2. Interconnected challenges to be addressed

- ☐ Based on your comprehensive joint analysis, this section should narrow down and focus on the interconnected challenges and opportunities to be addressed by the proposed programme.
- ☐ Explain and justify the selected challenges and geographical focus of the programme.
- ☐ Describe the entry-point(s) identified and explain the anticipated positive multiplier effects across other dimensions of human security and SDGs.
- ☐ List all relevant documents and sources used in an Annex. Provide hyperlinks when possible.

3. Rationale for funding and programme details

0.1. Workplan narrative

Explain what the programme is aiming to achieve and how it will address the interconnected challenges and opportunities at the local level described in the previous section. Explain how the proposed activities will lead to the collective outcomes and outputs identified as well as how they are anticipated to contribute to longer-term outcomes. To this end, please describe the:

- ☐ Objective(s) of the programme (i.e., the end result targeted or expected to occur as a consequence of the programme's efforts, at least in part, and to which the intervention, through the application of human security, is intended to contribute)
- ☐ Collective outcomes of the programme (*A collective outcome is a concrete and measurable result that actors from various sectors want to achieve jointly over a period of 3-5 years to reduce people's needs, risks and vulnerabilities and increase their resilience*).
- ☐ Expected outcomes, representing the changes that occur as a result of the completion of the outputs, and contribute to the attainment of the programme's objective.
- ☐ The outputs of the programme (i.e., the products and services needed to achieve an outcome and which result from the completion of programme activities).

- ☐ Activities that the proposed programme is expected to implement to obtain the stated outputs and outcomes (and collective outcomes) and to meaningfully contribute to the attainment of the objective(s)

In addition to the narrative above, please complete the Workplan tab of the [Workplan and Results Monitoring Template](#), available on the [UN Trust Fund for Human Security website](#). The workplan should cover all activities under the proposed programme, i.e. those funded by the UNTFHS and other funding sources. When activities are meant to be jointly implemented, please indicate so clearly. Please ensure SMART indicators for all outcomes and outputs, with adequate baselines and targets.

0.2. **Programme rationale**

- ☐ Provide a brief assessment of past initiatives by the UN, the government and other major stakeholders, and how they relate to the proposed programme. Explain what gaps exist in these past initiatives to address the situation.
- ☐ Provide a brief mapping of ongoing or planned initiatives by the UN, the government and other major stakeholders, and how they related to the proposed programme. Explain what gaps exist as well as areas of complementarity where synergies could be sought.
- ☐ Explain the programme's relationship to national and local priorities and the degree of commitments from national and local governments.
- ☐ Specifically highlight how the programme relates to the United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework (UNSDCF), and other relevant UN regional or national strategies.
- ☐ Explain how the proposed programme is different to previous responses and why it is the best approach to address the challenges identified. Please provide specific details/examples and refrain from general justifications.
- ☐ Please indicate if the proposed programme is being supported or is being considered for support by another UN funding mechanism.

0.3. **Programme development**

- ☐ Describe how this programme was identified and who has been involved. Explain in what ways the (i) national and local governments; (ii) beneficiaries and local communities; (iii) other UN organizations and international actors in the country, as well as (iv) any other stakeholders were engaged in the process of programme development.
- ☐ Explain how the UN entities involved in this programme were identified. Why are they best placed to address the identified challenges? How was the Lead Agency selected and why? How do the entities complement each other, not only by contributing to common outcomes but also by jointly implementing some key activities?
- ☐ Provide details on how non-UN partners were identified and why they are best placed to address the identified challenges.

0.4. **Implementing through the human security approach**

This section should explain and provide specific examples of how the programme will operationalize the human security approach in its design and implementation, especially in light of the relevance to the UNTFHS Guidelines, the Key Funding Criteria (IV) and the guidance provided in the Human Security Handbook. Please refrain from general justifications.

- ☐ Describe the multi-stakeholder and multi-sectoral nature of your programme. Highlight concrete synergies between your various collective activities, outputs and outcomes.
- ☐ Explain how this programme will capitalize on local knowledge, capacities and resources in responding to the identified challenges.
- ☐ Provide information on how the programme is making linkages between the local, municipal, national, regional and global levels, as relevant.
- ☐ Highlight how protective measures (top-down norms, policies and processes) will be linked to empowerment measures (capacity building, resilience, etc.)
- ☐ Describe how the programme is addressing the root causes or underlying drivers of the identified challenges and promoting a prevention-oriented approach.
- ☐ Explain how you will ensure an integrated, efficient and effective delivery of concrete outcomes and outputs.

0.5. **Beneficiaries**

Describe the direct and indirect beneficiaries of the proposed programme, disaggregated by gender, in terms of their (i) location; (ii) numbers; and (iii) if applicable, communities/ ethnicities. Describe the criteria used to select the beneficiaries, particularly with respect to achieving a balance between genders and different community/ethnic groups.

4. **Advancing the human security approach**

0.1. **Action plan for mainstreaming human security**

Develop on the activities for the integration and mainstreaming of the human security approach across the work of the UN and at the local, sub-national and national level that were included in the concept note and develop them into an action plan.

- ☐ The action plan must include concrete and time-bound activities for mainstreaming the human security approach as well as specific intended outcomes and should be budgeted accordingly.
- ☐ Include details of the processes through which the human security approach will be mainstreamed (i.e. CCA, UNSDCF, and other national planning processes, briefings, trainings, etc.)
- ☐ Explain the commitment of senior management to mainstreaming the human security approach across the UN Country Team beyond the duration and scope of this programme.

0.2. **Best practices and lessons learned**

- ☐ Explain how you will capture best practices and lessons learned on the value, opportunities and challenges of implementing the human security approach. This should include aspects related to the delivery of the programme (e.g. integrated workplans, steering committees, programme coordination mechanisms, etc.) as well as to the thematic issues addressed by the programme (e.g. working across agendas).
- ☐ Outline concrete tools or products that will be developed to garner and/or disseminate best practices and lessons learned for a broader audience, including the UN system and partners. These should be budgeted for accordingly.

5. Management structure and partnership strategy

0.1. Management structure

- ☐ Highlight strategic and programmatic structures you will establish to ensure effective and integrated implementation and oversight (e.g. Steering Committee, Coordination Committee, joint office space, etc.). Elaborate an organigram describing the proposed structure. A representative from the Human Security Unit should be included in programme Steering Committees.
- ☐ Outline the roles and responsibilities of each stakeholder, including the RCO, UN entities, sub-national and national government, civil society, international development partners and the private sector, among others.
- ☐ Explain how your proposed structure will ensure that the implementation of the activities is integrated and not taking place in silos. What mechanism(s) will you put in place to promote and ensure adequate synergies at the output level.
- ☐ Describe the role and responsibilities of the programme coordinator. The UNTFHS strongly encourages each programme to have a dedicated programme coordinator.

0.2. Participation of beneficiaries and governments

- ☐ Explain how beneficiaries and local communities, as well as national and local governments will be involved in the design, implementation and monitoring of the proposed programme and what results are expected. For human security programmes, participatory programme implementation and monitoring should go beyond bi-annual programme board meetings.
- ☐ Describe the structures to be created, including local programme management committees or participatory forums, etc. where all relevant stakeholders and affected communities can participate in decision-making, implementation and monitoring in a systematic manner.
- ☐ Explain how these community participation mechanisms will be sustained beyond the duration of the current programme.

0.3. Partnership with other organizations

Explain how the proposed programme will interact and engage with other international/national organizations, including NGOs and bilateral donors, operating in the same context.

0.4. Due diligence on engaging with non-UN entities

Please describe the due diligence process for engaging with non-UN entities (e.g., private sector entities, NGOs, foundations, etc.) undertaken by the relevant UN entity and confirm that it has been completed.

6. Risk management and sustainability

0.1. Risk management

Describe the main risks and potential negative externalities that could affect the proposed programme's success, their impact and probability, and the proposed mitigation measures using the format below. Risks should include fragmentation in the implementation of the activities and mitigation measures to ensure the programme is not implemented in silos.

Description of risks and negative externalities	Impact	Probability	Proposed mitigation measures	Responsible organization(s)

Note: Impact and probability should be indicated as high, medium or low.

0.2. Scale-up, replication and sustainability

- ☐ Provide a detailed and time-bound plan describing the provisions made to ensure the sustainability of the programme or its results and/or scale-up of the programme.
- ☐ Indicate specific efforts and activities to ensure the programme's scale-up, replication and sustainability from the start.
- ☐ Explain how the programme (as a multi-agency human security approach) will be expanded and/or replicated in other regions, or even other countries, through other sources of funding.
- ☐ Describe the expected roles of national and local government and institutions, as well as prospective donors, in ensuring the sustainability of the programme or its results after the conclusion of the funding from the UNTFHS.

7. Dissemination, public information and communications

Refer to the [Outreach Guidelines](#) and describe the strategy and action plan for dissemination and communicating the human security approach, explaining how the message (i.e. the vision, lessons learned and achievements) of the proposed programme will be disseminated to beneficiaries, national and local government, donors and other stakeholders. Explain how the proposed programme will help to raise the profile of the UN organizations in promoting the application of the human security approach and its contribution to the priorities of national governments and the international community. The budget for dissemination, public information and communication activities should be limited to a maximum of 3% of the programme budget for Window I programmes (excluding the programme support costs). For Window II programmes, the budget for dissemination, public information and communication activities should be commensurate with the activities and objective(s) of the programme.

Please include relevant joint communications activities in your Work Plan, which should include professionally produced and short, informal videos on the programme and the human security approach (please budget appropriately, including translation costs as needed).

8. Evaluation

The UNCT should conduct a final external evaluation from the human security perspective¹ and include the cost and timeline in the budget and the workplan. The (external) evaluation should be in line with the norms and standards adopted by the UN as well as the criteria of relevance, efficiency, effectiveness, impact (as possible), and sustainability.² While for Window II

¹ To ensure the evaluations are conducted from the human security perspective, UNCTs should refer to questions provided in the final assessment form (pp. 33-34) as guidance.

² Please refer to the United Nations Evaluation Group (uneval.org) for detailed guidance.

programmes of limited duration mid-term evaluations are encouraged, for operational (Window I) programmes mid-term evaluations, either internal or external, should be conducted.

Describe and budget the evaluation plan using the format below:

Evaluation title	Type	Time	Budget in US\$
Mid-term evaluation	Internal or external	Xth month	
Final evaluation	External	Xth month	

9. Budget

[**Note:** For joint programmes, only the parallel fund management option can be used. Operational details on the parallel fund management option are provided in Annex 7..]

- ☐ All programme proposals must include a programme budget using the [Budget Template for Programme Proposals](#) available on the [UN Trust Fund for Human Security website](#).
- ☐ The programme budget must be submitted as a separate excel file from the narrative programme proposal. The budget template must not be altered in any way. Addition of rows for additional objectives, outputs and activities are allowed as long as the template logic, formatting and formulas are maintained throughout. The lead agency/programme coordination staff must read the instructions included in top row of the excel template (red font).
- ☐ The programme budget must include Table 1 (Detailed Budget by Results) and Table 2 (Budget Summary by Reporting Object Class). If the programme is implemented by two or more UN implementing organizations, the programme budget must also include Table 3 (Budget Summary by Organization).
- ☐ In developing the budget, please keep in mind the criteria listed in Section IV.3 and Section VI of the Guidelines. For example, the budget must not include government staff salaries and institutional recurrent costs of UN agency operations (i.e. maintenance, utilities, office rent). Instead, the bulk of the funding must be used for programme activities with direct impact on vulnerable people and communities. While the HSU strongly recommend that a programme should include one dedicated Programme Coordinator, UNTFHS anticipates that salaries of staff would be a very modest component (e.g. 15-20% max) of the programme cost without the indirect support cost (7%). All general operating costs for running an office (e.g. telecommunication, rents, finance charges and other costs) should also be a very modest component (e.g. 5-10%).
- ☐ The budget must include indirect support costs of 7%. Please refer to Table 1, 2 and 3. For implementing organizations that are UN Secretariat departments/offices, their budget should not include the 7% indirect support cost as per guidance from the UN Controller's office.
- ☐ For joint programmes, only the parallel fund management option can be used. Operational details on the parallel fund management option are provided in Annex 7.
- ☐ The budget must include the HSU's mid-point assessment cost (one HSU staff travel cost and DSA for assessment including field visits).
- ☐ Contingencies or unforeseen costs arising during programme implementation will be considered on a case-by-case basis and therefore must not be included in the budget.

- ☐ To ensure consistency between budgeting and financial reporting, the programme team of each implementing organization should coordinate the development and management of its budget with its own finance team.
- ☐ Once the programme proposal is approved, all above-mentioned documentation will become an integral part of the financial agreement to be signed.
- ☐ The financial reporting of all implementing organizations must be within the authorized approved budget lines (Table 1. Detailed Budget by Results and Table 2. Budget Summary by reporting object class per implementing organization). A variance equal to or more than 20% from the approved budget requires HSU approval. Financial reallocations made without prior consultation with the HSU will not be accepted, and the funds may have to be reimbursed to the UNTFHS.
- ☐ A budget variance <20% from the approved programme budget (Table 2) does not require HSU approval but the lead agency/programme coordination staff is expected to promptly inform the HSU.

Guidance for completion of Table 1: Detailed Budget by Results

- ☐ This table aims at providing sufficient details on the implementation arrangements and utilization of the UNTFHS funds. Table 1 should be consistent with the details provided in the Programme Details of the programme proposal.
- ☐ Table 1 displays each activity by item (\$/Unit/Quantity) and annual resource requirements (annual budget). The former provides information on the implementation arrangements of the activity, while the annual budget for the same line translates the workplan document in terms of cost. The total columns of these two components (item budget and annual budget) should have identical values by line. The example will provide additional clarification.
- ☐ Each budget item line must indicate the object class under which the cost will be reported. This information is important as it will define the value computed for table 2 Budget by reporting object class. The data entered in this column will ensure alignment of progress narrative reports with financial reporting.
- ☐ Programme coordination costs must include: (1) the breakdown of all programme personnel (UN staff) salaries, which are covered by the programme, and including their roles and responsibilities. For part-time personnel, indicate the percentage of time allocated to the programme. Ensure that all personnel mentioned in the narrative are included here. (2) the breakdown for dissemination, public affairs and communications costs; (3) a line for monitoring and evaluation costs; (4) any programme acquisitions, operating expenses, or travel not listed under the activities above; and (5) any other additional costs not listed under the programme activities.
- ☐ Additional general instructions and guidance are available in the excel budget template, tab1: Detailed budget by results in red font.

Guidance for completion of Table 2: Budget Summary by Reporting Object Class

- ☐ This table must be populated based on the assigned reporting object class of table 1. The example in the template should exemplify.
- ☐ The aim of table 2 is to clearly indicate the allocations of funds by reporting object class (expenditures of financial report). The financial reporting will be reviewed against the approved budget allocation by implementing organization of Table 2. For more details on

tolerance variance please see above (> and < 20%) and Annex 5, “Programme and Budget Revision”.

Guidance for completion of Table 3: Budget Summary by Organization

- ☐ If the programme is implemented by two or more UN implementing organizations, the programme budget must also include table 3 (Budget Summary by Organization).
- ☐ This table must be populated based on the annual Total Programme Cost by implementing organizations of table 2. The example in the template should be of assistance.

Checklist for the Programme Proposal

Prior to submitting your programme proposal, please review the following and ensure all elements are completed.

Programmatic

- ☐ Do you have a letter of approval/support from the relevant national and/or local government?
- ☐ Is the proposal endorsed by the UNRC or relevant highest-ranking UN Official, and under his/her overall oversight and leadership?
- ☐ Does your proposal demonstrate the use of the human security approach both as an analytical and programming tool? Have you adequately explained the interconnected challenges and how the UN entities and partners will address them in an integrated manner (including concrete synergies at the activity level)?
- ☐ Are you confident in the effectiveness of the proposed strategy to mainstream the human security approach within the UN System and beyond? What about your actions aimed at replicability, scale-up and sustainability?
- ☐ Are you confident your proposed management structure will maximize the opportunities for joint activities and integration among UN Agencies and partners?
- ☐ Have you maximized opportunities for beneficiaries to participate throughout the programme cycle?
- ☐ Does your workplan and results monitoring matrix include SMART indicators for all outcomes and outputs (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time bound) with adequate baselines, target and timeframe?
- ☐ Did you complete the risk management matrix?
- ☐ Have you included all of the relevant Terms of References (e.g. consultants, Programme Steering Committee, Technical Working Group)?

Financial

- ☐ Did you complete tables 1, 2 and 3 in Budget Template for Programme Proposals?
- ☐ Did you delete all instructions in red and examples in blue? Did you retain all the required text in black? Did you prepare the excel budget document in line with the provided instructions? Did you consult with your organization's finance team?
- ☐ Is the requested grant amount consistent on all documentation?
- ☐ Did you ensure all UN Agencies/Implementing Partners have a common understanding of each object class definition?
- ☐ Do you meet the pooled funding requirement and did you include the specific funding source(s)? Do you have evidence that those sources of funding are confirmed?
- ☐ Did you budget for:
 - Programme coordination (workshops, monitoring missions, etc.)
 - Outreach and communication activities (including professionally made video(s) and photographs)
 - Mid-term and final evaluations
 - One mission for the Human Security Unit (one staff from New York – airfare and DSA)

Role of the lead agency for UNTFHS programmes

As all UNTFHS programmes are multidimensional, multiagency, and multi-partner, the role of the lead agency is crucial, particularly with regard to the genuine integration of activities and the required coordination among implementing partners, as well as communication with implementing and non-implementing partners, among others. The lead agency is therefore not necessarily the entity with the most significant substantive role or largest amount of funding from the UNTFHS, but the agency best suited in the particular context to oversee and drive integration and coordination towards the shared objectives of the human security programme.

Key responsibilities of the lead agency

Coordinating overall programme implementation in line with the human security approach. The lead agency will be responsible for organizing meetings and consultations with all programme partners, including but not limited to steering committee and technical working group meetings, to ensure integrated implementation of the programme.

Establishing the appropriate governance structures and coordinating mechanisms for a successful human security programme at the national and community levels (or global and regional levels, as relevant for the programme).

Managing timely communication and consolidation of the inputs required from the implementing partners for the development of annual work plans, M&E plans, communications strategies, mainstreaming efforts as well as narrative and financial reports submitted to the HSU.

Designating a programme coordinator who will serve as the primary focal point for the programme. The coordinator will play a key role in managing and monitoring programme implementation.

Ensuring that all programme activities are in line with the approved programme proposal and budget, and apply the human security approach.